

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ J 7 3
♦ K Q 4 3
♣ A 10 5 2

♠ A K J 9 6 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ A 6

♣ K 3



♠ 10 8 3
♥ K Q 10 4
♦ J 8
♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ Q 7

♥ A 8 2

♦ 10 9 7 5 2

♣ Q J 8

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥K.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have one loser to get rid of. Your best approach is to establish a ♣ in dummy to take care of your ♦ loser. You can't pull trumps yet because you need the ♠Q as an entry.

Win the ♥A. Play a ♣ to the ♣K, then another ♣. A defender will probably win this one and they will take two ♥s. But then they must give you the lead. You enter dummy with the ♠Q and dump your ♦6 on the good ♣. Then you pull trumps and claim.

With the ♥ lead you first take the ♥A, then establish a ♣ to discard your ♦ loser, using the ♠Q as an entry.

If the opening lead had been a ♦ you would first take the ♦A, then pull trumps, then establish a ♣ to discard a ♥ loser, using the ♥A as an entry.

If the opening lead had been a ♠ you would pull trumps, then establish a ♣ to discard a red loser on, using the ♥A as an entry.

The same general plan, but with slightly different details, applies with all opening leads.

With 10 points you aren't strong enough to respond at the 2-level, particularly with that weak ♦ suit.

So you bid 1NT. Partner jumps to 3♠.

Your 10 points are looking better now that you know partner has at least 16. That puts you at game-going strength.

And your ♠ Q 7 looks better too, knowing that partner has 6 ♠s.

So you bid 4♠.

South would play 4♠.

Click

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 8 5
♥ K J 8 7 4
♦ -
♣ Q 9 8

♠ 6 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A K Q 7 6 4

♣ 4 2



♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 10

♦ J 10 9 5 2

♣ K 6 5

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 9 6

♦ 8 3

♣ A J 10 7 3

With 11 points and a beautiful 6-card suit this is the perfect hand for a Weak-2 opener. So you open 2♦. Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. You are expected to rebid your suit if you have a minimum (6-8 point) hand. Otherwise you are to bid an outside suit in which you hold a high card - this is called "showing a feature". And the final possibility is this one, where you have a solid suit, either A K Q x x x or A K J 10 x x. In this case you bid 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

North would play 3NT.

Click

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠J. East plays ♠K.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠J. East plays ♠K.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 7

The ♠ lead assures you of two tricks in the suit. So you only need to create two more. If the ♦s split 3-2 (likely) you could get 3 extra tricks there. But there's a danger - if they split 4-1 you wouldn't have an entry to them. Well, you wouldn't have an entry unless you **DUCKED** the first ♦. Then a 4-1 split wouldn't prevent you from making 5 ♦ winners.

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

West shows out.Make **PLAN B**, then

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

West shows out.

That's tough. No matter how you play them you can only get 3 ♦ winners. So you must turn elsewhere - elsewhere being the ♣ suit.

Win the ♦Q but don't play another ♦ yet, you need an entry back to dummy later. Instead, lead the ♣2 and finesse your ♣10. West will win with one of the high ♣s and probably return a ♠. You may as well take the ♠Q now. Play your ♦8 to dummy's ♦K, cash the ♦A, then play the ♣4, finessing your ♣J. Fortunately this wins and when you cash your ♣A both defenders follow. The rest of your clubs are good and you make an overtrick.

Sometimes you have to change your plan.

When the ♦s turned out to be 5-0 you had to get lucky. Your back-up Plan wasn't likely to work - it required the missing ♣ honors to be split, but also required a 3-3 ♣ split, not a likely outcome.

But there was no other choice so you have to try it.